

“Come in,” he said in a friendly tone. “Take a seat. Before we begin, let’s pray.”

As Bryan was asking the Lord to give them wisdom in their time together, Ben realized that it had been months since he had even felt the desire to pray or read the Bible, although both had been habits for most of his life. The pressures they were under seemed to have stripped him of his ability to concentrate. He realized the same must have been true for Naomi.

When he finished praying, Bryan said, “Ben, tell me what you think the problems are.”

Ben was surprised by the question, because he had expected that a financial coach would ask to see the multitude of records they had brought with them. “I honestly don’t know. I suppose it has to be my handling of the money. We never seem to have enough to pay all the bills. We still owe Naomi’s dad for most of the loan he made so we could catch up. We owe for two cars, a consolidation loan with the credit union, and our house. And the repayment plan from the bankruptcy.”

“Thanks, Ben,” he said.

Then turning to Naomi, Bryan asked, “What do you think the problem is?”

“Well, I guess it’s much like Ben said, except that I believe the real problem—at least in our marriage—is that we don’t discuss things. We argue, and I see it getting worse instead of better.”

“Are you willing to make the changes necessary to cure the problems, rather than just treat the symptoms?” Bryan asked them both.

“I’m ready to do whatever I have to do,” Ben said.

“I think I am too,” agreed Naomi.

“Good,” Bryan replied. “Especially since I believe God put you two together to operate as a team. I generally find that when a husband and wife work together, they each bring a needed